

Lesson 8: The Client Simulation

Before You Start

Everything in this lesson — the client, the club, the emails, the feedback — is **fictional**, built for practice. No real payment changes hands, and no document here is a real, legally binding contract. What's real is the *skill* you're practicing: this is exactly how a real client engagement flows, start to finish.

What You'll Learn

How a complete client engagement actually works: inquiry → discovery → proposal → delivery → feedback → revision → handoff — by living through all six stages with one fictional client.

Why It Matters

Every service you'll ever offer, real or simulated, follows this same shape. Practicing it end-to-end, safely, means your first *real* client engagement won't be your first time doing any of these steps.

Your Fictional Client

Career Compass Club — a student-run school club helping classmates explore career paths. Their faculty advisor, **Priya Alvarez**, has reached out needing help. Full details are in [Simulation_Resources/Fictional_Client_Profile.md](#).

Step-by-Step

1. Read [Simulation_Resources/Client_Inquiry_Email.md](#) — this is how the engagement starts.
2. Take part in the Discovery Call role-play — your instructor plays Priya. Take real notes; you'll need them.
3. Fill out [Simulation_Resources/Project_Requirements.md](#) based on what you learned.
4. Draft a Proposal using the Lesson 7 Proposal Template, and complete the [Pricing_Scope_Worksheet.md](#).
5. Get peer feedback, revise, and "submit" your proposal.
6. Read [Simulation_Resources/Client_Feedback.md](#) and [Revision_Request.md](#) — the client approved your proposal but wants one change. Make it, and document what you changed.
7. Complete the [Final_Handoff_Checklist.md](#) and write a short, professional handoff message.
8. Finish the [Reflection_Worksheet.md](#).

Key Terms

Term	Meaning
Discovery	Asking questions to understand a client's real need before proposing anything
Scope	Exactly what is and isn't included in a project
Revision request	A client's ask for a specific change after seeing your work
Handoff	The final, professional delivery of finished work with clear instructions

Knowledge Check

1. Name the six stages of this client engagement, in order.
2. Why do you ask discovery questions instead of proposing something right away?
3. What's the difference between a reasonable revision request and scope creep?
4. Why is this simulation clearly labeled as fictional and non-binding?
5. What makes a handoff message "professional" rather than just "finished"?

Reflection

1. What part of this simulation felt most like a real professional situation?
2. What would you do differently with a real client based on this practice?
3. Could this simulated project become a new Course 16 case study? Why or why not?

Submission

Submit your completed Project Requirements notes, Proposal, Pricing/Scope Worksheet, revision documentation, and Handoff Checklist as one package.